Community Stabilization Unit - Early Recovery Initiative

Community Atmospheric Panels

AWDHEGLE

SOUTHWEST STATE OF SOMALIA | MARCH 2026

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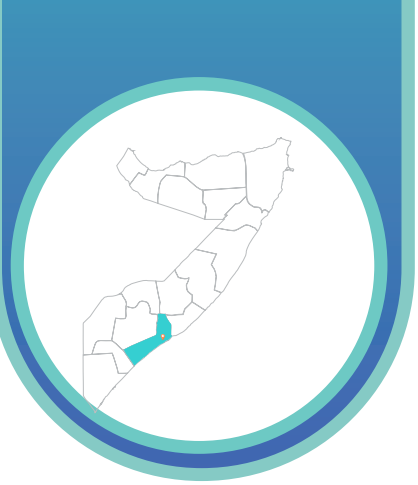

CAPs

Areas of focus

Living conditions

Recovery initiatives

Governance

Security

Justice

Media

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report presents the findings of the Community Atmospheric Panels (CAPs) assessment conducted in Awdhegle district between 24 and 29 November 2025. The assessment revealed that Awdhegle remains at a critical juncture in its post-conflict recovery. Years of conflict, prolonged drought, and repeated displacement have devastated livelihoods, infrastructure, and food security. Agricultural lands and storage facilities were destroyed, markets disrupted, and essential services, including schools, health centres, and water systems, damaged. Women, children, and other vulnerable groups have been disproportionately affected, and many households continue to struggle with high food prices, limited income, and poor access to basic services.

Despite these challenges, meaningful progress has been achieved in stabilisation. The re-liberation of Awdhegle from al-Shabaab, supported by the Somali National Army (SNA) and the African Union Support and Stabilisation Mission in Somalia (AUSSOM), has restored security, enabled freedom of movement, and facilitated the gradual return of displaced residents. Enhanced security measures, including regular patrols and controlled entry points, have reduced misconduct, increased public confidence, and allowed economic activity to resume. Markets and small businesses are gradually reopening, with returnees contributing to local commerce, though economic recovery remains fragile due to high commodity prices, limited financial support, and minimal NGO-led interventions.

Governance in Awdhegle is broadly inclusive of major clans, fostering social cohesion and trust in local leadership, while the absence of internal political rivalries has strengthened collective focus on recovery. Nonetheless, formal governance mechanisms, including a district council, remain absent, and women and youth are excluded from decision-making processes, limiting the inclusivity and responsiveness of governance structures. Access to justice remains heavily reliant on traditional mechanisms, particularly the Xeer system, which is widely trusted but constrained by inconsistencies, lack of formal courts, and limited legal awareness, highlighting the need for complementary formal legal services.

Social and Economic Challenges

- Livelihood destruction
- Market disruption
- Service shortages
- Limited income

Governance and Security Challenges

- Informal justice
- Limited inclusion
- Weak institutions

The district's information ecosystem is layered and adaptive, combining radio, social media, telephone communication, and interpersonal networks. Generational and gender disparities, low digital literacy, limited electricity, and a lack of localised content constrain equitable access and heighten the risk of misinformation. Reliable, timely information is critical for security, recovery, and civic engagement, underscoring the importance of strengthening communication infrastructure and digital literacy initiatives.

Demographics and Geographic Profile

Awdhegle is a prominent agricultural district and town in the Lower Shabelle region, situated roughly 60–70 km west of the capital, Mogadishu, along the fertile banks of the Shabelle River. The area sits within one of Somalia's most productive irrigated agricultural zones, a factor that has long underpinned its economic and strategic significance. The Shabelle River creates rich soils that support crop cultivation and pastoral livelihoods, making Awdhegle and its surrounding settlements key to local food production and rural livelihoods. The district's location along routes linking Mogadishu with the interior further enhances its importance for trade and mobility within Southwest State and beyond.

Accurate population data for Awdhegle District remains limited due to the absence of a recent national census and the lack of publicly available disaggregated district-level figures. However, local authorities estimate that the district comprises approximately 19,000 households. While this figure should be interpreted as indicative rather than definitive, it suggests that Awdhegle is among the more densely populated districts in the Lower Shabelle Region.

Clan composition in Awdhegle is relatively diverse but dominated by indigenous riverine and farming communities. Prominent local groups include Garre and Geledi (both part of the wider Rahanweyn or Digil-Mirifle clan), as well as Sheikhal (a Hawiye-associated community). These groups largely engage in agriculture and maintain social cohesion through strong councils of elders, and the district has historically experienced lower levels of traditional clan conflict compared to some neighbouring areas.

METHODOLOGY

The CAPs were designed to systematically gather and analyse community perceptions on key socio-political dynamics, with a particular focus on recovery efforts, safety and security, governance arrangements, access to justice, and media consumption patterns. The methodology prioritised inclusivity, methodological rigor, and contextual sensitivity to ensure the findings accurately reflected community realities.

To promote informed and meaningful participation, facilitators undertook structured preparatory engagement with community members seven days prior to the CAP sessions. This pre-engagement phase served to familiarise participants with the objectives and thematic focus of the discussions, clarify expectations, and establish trust and rapport between facilitators and participants. Such groundwork proved critical in fostering open dialogue and encouraging candid contributions during the sessions.

At the commencement of each CAP session, facilitators clearly outlined the study objectives and methodology. Informed consent was obtained from all participants, and participants jointly agreed on ground rules to guide respectful, inclusive, and orderly discussions. These measures helped create a safe and constructive environment conducive to high-quality qualitative data collection.

To ensure diversity of perspectives and reduce selection bias, the research team randomly selected 35 community members, comprising 19 men (54 percent) and 16 women (46 percent). Participants were drawn from different clans, age groups, and occupational backgrounds to reflect the district's demographic composition. The sample included a cross-section of community segments, such as elders, youth (both male and female), and women, thereby capturing intergenerational and gendered perspectives on the issues under study.

24 - 29 November

CAPs group discussions

Participants were divided into:

3

Focus Groups

Focus groups composition

Female

Male

Key discussion points

- Recovery efforts & humanitarian stabilisation
- Perceptions of community safety and major security threats
- Governance & local leadership

In addition to the CAP discussions, KIIs were conducted to triangulate findings and enrich the analysis with institutional and sector-specific insights. Key informants included a deputy District Commissioner (DC), a traditional community leader, members of the security apparatus, and a local businesswoman. These interviews provided critical perspectives on governance, security dynamics, local administration, and economic conditions that complemented the community-level discussions.

All CAP sessions and KIIs were conducted through face-to-face interviews between 24 and 29 November 2025. No interviews were conducted remotely or via telephone, ensuring consistency in data collection and enabling facilitators to observe non-verbal cues and contextual factors that enhanced the depth and reliability of the findings.

FINDINGS

Security and Political Conditions

Overview and Needs of Security Actors

Security in Awdhegle is currently underpinned by the strong presence of AUSSOM and the SNA, whose coordinated operations have significantly improved stability since the town's re-liberation. AUSSOM controls key entry and exit points and conducts regular patrols, strengthening deterrence and boosting public confidence. The SNA complements these efforts through systematic screening of newcomers, inspections of goods, joint patrols, and intelligence sharing. Strong collaboration among the SNA, AUSSOM, and district authorities was consistently cited as a key factor in the town's improved security environment, enabling rapid responses to emerging threats. While Darwish forces and formal police units are not currently active in the district, local militias appear to play only a limited role. AS has no overt presence in the town but remains a latent threat in surrounding areas.

The most urgent needs centre on sustaining current security gains and strengthening transition readiness. AUSSOM requires continued operational presence, predictable logistical support, and clear transition planning to avoid premature withdrawal that could destabilise the area. The SNA requires further capacity-building, including advanced training, equipment, and strengthened command-and-control systems to assume progressively greater responsibilities. The absence of Darwish and police forces underscores the need to establish formal regional and civilian policing structures to ensure long-term stabilisation and rule of law. Maintaining strong coordination among security actors, reinforcing inclusive governance, and enhancing preparedness against potential AS infiltration remain critical to consolidating stability and preventing regression.

Perceptions of Security Actors

Youth participants highlighted significant improvements in security following the deployment of AUSSOM forces. They noted a reduction in misconduct and indiscipline, particularly among armed personnel. One youth remarked, "The random shooting by some SNA soldiers stopped once AUSSOM arrived." The lifting of the previous curfew, which had restricted movement between 5:00 p.m. and 7:00 a.m., was widely welcomed and has restored freedom of movement, especially during evening hours. While residents are now able to move more freely, respondents acknowledged that strict screening of newcomers remains in place, which they viewed as a necessary measure to prevent infiltration and safeguard community security.

Women similarly reported feeling safer in their daily lives due to improved stability. However, they expressed deep concern about the potential withdrawal of AUSSOM forces. Many feared that a security vacuum could allow al-Shabaab to attempt a return. Regular patrols and visible security operations were cited as key factors contributing to residents' sense of reassurance.

The Deputy DC strongly endorsed the current security arrangements, describing the security environment in Awdhegle as stable and reliable. He emphasised AUSSOM's central role in maintaining peace and deterring threats. **"Their presence has boosted public confidence and made people feel truly safe in their own town."** He further explained that AUSSOM's control of entry and exit points has been instrumental in preventing unauthorised access and maintaining order. However, he cautioned that a premature withdrawal could expose the town to serious security risks, as local forces are not yet fully equipped to assume full responsibility. Elders echoed these views, stressing that AUSSOM's presence is critical and currently irreplaceable.

Youth respondents commended the SNA's diligence in monitoring the movement of goods, noting that all items entering and leaving the town are carefully inspected to prevent supplies from reaching insurgent groups. They also highlighted strong coordination between the SNA, AUSSOM, and the district administration, which has enhanced rapid response and threat mitigation. Women participants praised the SNA's consistent presence and responsiveness. One woman stated, **"Their continued presence on the ground gives us peace of mind."** Elders similarly acknowledged the SNA's effectiveness, particularly in conducting regular patrols and preventing infiltration.

The deputy DC affirmed these assessments, stating that the SNA plays a vital role alongside AUSSOM. He noted that security services have improved significantly since the town's re-liberation, resulting in a calmer environment, increased public trust, and stronger cooperation between residents and local authorities.

Importantly, participants unanimously reported that there are no specific security threats currently targeting women or youth.

Overview of Government Structure & Representation

Participants confirmed that the local administration in Awdhegle is currently functional and inclusive. According to the deputy DC and other respondents, all major clans are represented in leadership positions, structured as follows:

» **DC:** Bagadi clan

» **Deputy DC for Social Affairs:** Biyamal clan

» **Deputy DC for Security Affairs:** Garre clan

Respondents widely viewed this inclusive representation as a positive factor in promoting fairness, preventing marginalisation, and fostering social cohesion. Youth and women participants noted that broad clan inclusion has strengthened trust in local leadership and encouraged more balanced decision-making. No minority clans were reported to be excluded.

However, a formal local council has not yet been established. Youth participants expressed frustration, noting that the absence of a council limits opportunities for educated youth to participate in governance. **"We want the local council to be formed immediately so our voices can be heard."**

Regarding gender and youth representation, respondents confirmed that women currently hold no formal positions within the local administration. While women remain active in social and economic life and are occasionally invited to meetings, their exclusion from formal decision-making limits their influence. Women participants stressed that this gap reduces their ability to address issues affecting women and children. Elders attributed women's exclusion to the complexity of appointment processes by the Ministry of Interior and entrenched clan-based power-sharing norms. Nonetheless, they expressed a strong desire for increased inclusion of women in future leadership roles.

Relations between the Awdhegle administration, the community, and both Federal Government of Somalia (FGS) and Southwest State authorities were described as positive and cooperative. Respondents highlighted mutual trust, open communication, and strong collaboration on security matters. Despite this positive relationship, several respondents, including a traditional leader, expressed concern over essential services. The local mother and child health centre and school were severely damaged during al-Shabaab's occupation, with most equipment destroyed. Respondents urged both FGS and state authorities to prioritise rehabilitation of these facilities.

Perceptions of Government Structure & Representation

Participants agreed that there are currently no political rivalries or internal tensions in Awdhegle. Both community leaders and residents remain focused on recovery, reconciliation, and rebuilding livelihoods in the aftermath of prolonged conflict. Rather than engaging in political competition, stakeholders have prioritised restoring social cohesion, addressing immediate humanitarian needs, and laying the foundations for long-term stability and development. Youth participants emphasised that the absence of internal political rivalry has fostered a collaborative environment characterised by shared responsibility and collective problem-solving. As one youth participant explained, **"Everyone is working together to rebuild Awdhegle. No one is pushing political agendas."** This unity was widely viewed as a critical factor enabling the community to concentrate its efforts on reconstruction and social recovery.

A traditional community leader further reinforced this assessment, noting that the only form of rivalry currently affecting Awdhegle is the broader conflict between the government and al-Shabaab.

Across participant groups, **trust in federal and state authorities** were described as strong, though still evolving. Respondents noted that this trust is anchored not only in tangible achievements to date—most notably the successful re-liberation of Awdhegle—but also in expectations of sustained government engagement. Community members expressed hope that the government will build on recent security gains by expanding support in critical areas such as social service delivery, infrastructure rehabilitation, and inclusive governance. A traditional community leader echoed these views, observing that trust in government institutions has grown significantly as a result of the improved security environment. This level of protection has **"created a sense of safety and stability that the people value deeply,"** and has strengthened community support for state-led stabilisation efforts.

Economic Conditions

Current Living Standards

Participants provided a comprehensive overview of the prevailing socio-economic conditions in Awdhegle, describing a slow but discernible transition from conflict-induced collapse toward early-stage recovery. This shift has been shaped primarily by improved security conditions and the gradual return of displaced residents, though significant vulnerabilities persist. Participants noted gradual improvements since October. The return of displaced residents has injected renewed economic activity into the town, contributing to increased market activity and social interaction. As one participant observed, **"People are slowly coming back, and that brings life back to the town—you can feel it in the markets and on the streets."** Families have begun repairing homes, resuming agricultural activities, and restarting small businesses.

Participants also reported that local shops have reopened and markets are functioning again, restoring access to essential goods and services. A youth participant noted, **"Before, the market was empty—now you can find food, clothes, and even phone credit again."** This revival of local commerce has created modest income-generating opportunities, particularly for women engaged in petty trade and informal businesses. Nevertheless, the cost of basic commodities continues to be high, and access to capital or financial support for small enterprises is extremely limited. Several respondents highlighted the absence of targeted assistance for returning IDPs, many of whom struggle to secure adequate shelter, clean water, and food. Participants stressed that without structured support, economic recovery risks stagnation.

NGOs Activities

Participants reported that recovery efforts in Awdhegle are largely community-driven, with minimal engagement from NGOs or development actors. An SNA officer noted that security forces have provided limited food assistance to returnees, particularly during the initial return phase. Elders and other respondents noted that while individuals with financial means have begun rebuilding homes and reopening businesses, recovery remains slow and unequal due to the absence of NGO-led interventions.

Recovery Efforts

A key positive development identified by participants is the successful re-establishment of government control over Awdhegle by the SNA with support from AUSSOM. This security improvement has enabled residents to return and begin rebuilding despite widespread destruction of livelihoods and housing. However, participants reported significant gaps in stabilisation and recovery. There are no comprehensive recovery programmes in place, and critical public infrastructure-including the administration building, schools, hospitals, and health clinics-remains damaged or non-functional. Participants noted that the nearest operational public facilities are located in Afgoye, approximately 50 km away, severely limiting access to essential services.

IDPs Considerations

Participants emphasised that Awdhegle is primarily managing the return and reintegration of its own displaced population rather than hosting new IDPs from other areas. Women participants reported that there are currently no active IDP camps within the town. Most residents who fled during peak conflict have returned. However, some families remain displaced in Afgoye and Mogadishu due to financial constraints. Prior to the conflict, Awdhegle did not host IDP populations. During the crisis, some families established informal settlements in nearby agricultural areas to avoid both military operations and insurgent threats. A community leader reinforced this perspective, noting that while the majority of residents returned voluntarily and began rebuilding immediately, those remaining displaced face financial—not security—barriers.

Community Perceptions

Women participants expressed strong concern that recovery efforts have not extended beyond security. They stressed the absence of healthcare services, education support, infrastructure rehabilitation, and livelihood programmes. One woman stated, **"We need more than just peace-we need healthcare, schools, and roads. Right now, nothing has been done to fix these."** This lack of social services was widely viewed as a critical barrier to sustainable recovery.

Youth participants identified the government's role in reclaiming Awdhegle as a pivotal moment in rebuilding public confidence. **"When the government forces helped reclaim our town, it gave people hope, we started to believe again that the government is standing with us."** They further noted that the continued security presence, combined with close cooperation between government forces and AUSSOM, has reinforced confidence that the town's stability can be sustained over time. **"Once people felt safe, they came back and immediately started fixing their houses. It gave them hope."**

The minority community, the Somali Bantu, perceives that it participates in the district's governance system and recovery efforts. Many youths from the minority community join the security forces, as it is one of the most populous communities, but remain unarmed compared with other major clans. The minority are heavily involved in farming and agricultural practices, both as landowners and casual labourers. The minority perceive that they are not denied deployment in the security forces or in casual agricultural labour forces in the district. Still, they stress that they sometimes experience civil unrest, which leads them to migrate to urban areas such as Mogadishu.

Justice Systems

Participants consistently reported that traditional justice mechanisms, particularly the Xeer system, remain the most accessible and trusted form of justice in Awdhegle. In the absence of functioning formal courts, community members overwhelmingly rely on elders and customary law to resolve disputes. An elder explained, **"When problems occur, people come to us first. We settle issues quickly and fairly according to Xeer."** Xeer is widely used to address family disputes, land conflicts, and minor criminal cases due to its speed, affordability, and social legitimacy. While Sharia law plays a role in family and inheritance matters, it is typically administered through religious leaders rather than formal institutions. Formal justice mechanisms are rarely accessed due to distance, limited functionality, and low trust.

Participants identified multiple barriers to equitable justice. Youth cited clan dominance, insecurity, and lack of neutral institutions as major concerns. Elders highlighted inconsistencies between clan-based Xeer systems, which can complicate dispute resolution. Traditional leaders and the Deputy DC underscored the absence of courts, trained legal personnel, and public legal awareness. Women expressed concern that reliance on clan systems often disadvantages women, particularly in cases involving rights and protection.

Media and Information Accessibility

Overview of Media Platforms

Participants identified radio and interpersonal communication as the most trusted sources of information in Awdhegle. Radio Shabelle was consistently cited, particularly by elders and business owners, as a reliable source for security updates and public information due to its accessibility and credibility. Elders and local leaders also emphasised in-person meetings with the local administration and security forces as critical for receiving verified information. Youth participants reported heavy reliance on social media platforms such as Facebook and WhatsApp, valuing speed and accessibility.

Women participants highlighted a clear generational divide in access to and use of information channels within Awdhegle. Younger women reported frequent use of social media to obtain news and updates, particularly related to security and community developments. Older women rely predominantly on word-of-mouth communication, drawing information from trusted conversations with neighbours, family members, and friends. A businesswoman offered a concise summary of this blended information landscape: **"Radio Shabelle and social media are the go-to sources, but telephone calls are just as critical. I called friends and relatives before I returned from Mogadishu to check if it was safe. That's how we verify what we hear on the radio or online."**

Perceptions, Preferences, and Challenges to Accessibility

Participants identified several structural and social barriers that continue to limit equitable and timely access to information in Awdhegle. These challenges disproportionately affect women, older adults, and residents in more remote areas of the district. Limited access to electricity and communication devices was cited as a significant constraint. Low levels of digital literacy, especially among older adults and women, further restrict the effective use of social media and digital communication platforms. As a result, these groups often remain excluded from real-time information flows, increasing their reliance on secondary sources and interpersonal networks. Participants also highlighted language barriers and the limited availability of localised content as key obstacles.

The absence of a community radio station broadcasting hyper-local content was repeatedly identified as a notable gap. Respondents stressed that such a platform could play a vital role in reaching residents in outlying areas, delivering verified information, and strengthening community awareness on local developments. Finally, while oral communication networks remain an important and trusted source of information, over-reliance on these channels—particularly during urgent situations—was recognised as a risk. Participants noted that information passed informally can be delayed, distorted, or contribute to the spread of rumours.

CONCLUSION & RECOMMENDATIONS

The CAPs findings present Awdhegle as a district at a pivotal moment in its post-conflict trajectory. Following its re-liberation from al-Shabaab, the town has made tangible progress toward stabilisation, driven primarily by improved security conditions under the SNA, with the support of AUSSOM, and the reactivation of a local administration. These gains have enabled freedom of movement, the voluntary return of displaced residents, and the gradual reopening of markets and small businesses—restoring a measure of normalcy and optimism among the population.

Social cohesion has been further reinforced by the absence of internal political rivalries and the presence of broadly inclusive clan representation within the local administration. This unity has fostered trust, collective responsibility, and a shared focus on recovery rather than political competition. Trust in both FGS and FMS authorities remain generally positive and is closely linked to recent security improvements. However, this trust is conditional and increasingly shaped by community expectations for sustained engagement and visible progress in service delivery, infrastructure rehabilitation, and economic recovery.

Despite these positive developments, the findings clearly demonstrate that security gains alone are insufficient to secure long-term stabilisation. Living conditions remain highly fragile due to prolonged drought, widespread destruction of livelihoods and infrastructure, and limited access to essential services. Economic recovery is underway but remains slow, uneven, and largely dependent on community resilience rather than structured support. High food prices, lack of capital, damaged public facilities, and limited livelihood opportunities continue to constrain household recovery, disproportionately affecting women, returnees, and other vulnerable groups.

Governance structures in Awdhegle are functioning and have contributed to stability, yet significant institutional gaps persist. The absence of a formal district council and the continued exclusion of women and youth from formal decision-making processes undermine inclusive governance and risk eroding long-term legitimacy. While women and young people play active roles in social and economic life, their limited influence over formal governance restricts the responsiveness and representativeness of local leadership.

Access to justice remains heavily reliant on traditional mechanisms, particularly the Xeer system, which is widely trusted due to its accessibility and social legitimacy. However, the lack of formal courts, trained legal personnel, and legal awareness raises concerns regarding consistency, equity, and the protection of vulnerable groups, highlighting the need for complementary formal justice structures.

Information access in Awdhegle reflects a layered and adaptive communication ecosystem. Radio, interpersonal communication, social media, and telephone networks are used in parallel, shaped by generational preferences, technological access, and trust dynamics. While this system demonstrates strong community-based verification practices, it is constrained by limited electricity, low digital literacy, insufficient localised content, and the absence of a community radio platform. These gaps increase the risk of delayed or distorted information, particularly during periods of heightened insecurity.

The findings from the CAP highlight that Awdhegle has achieved meaningful security and social cohesion gains following its re-liberation from al-Shabaab. However, these gains remain fragile and require coordinated, multi-dimensional interventions to ensure sustainable stabilisation, recovery, and development.

- Consolidating security gains should remain a priority. Maintaining the current presence of AUSSOM and the SNA is critical to prevent the re-emergence of security vacuums and insurgent infiltration. A phased transition plan should be developed to gradually strengthen the capacity of national and local security forces, ensuring any drawdown of international forces is carefully conditions-based. Close coordination between security actors and the district administration, including joint patrols and community engagement, will be essential to sustain public confidence and rapid threat response.
- Accelerating the restoration of basic services and infrastructure is a key next step. Prioritising the rehabilitation of critical public infrastructure—such as schools, the mother-and-child health centre, administrative buildings, and water systems—will provide tangible peace dividends that reinforce public trust. Rapid-impact service restoration in health, education, and water access is needed to address urgent humanitarian needs while laying the foundation for longer-term development. Infrastructure rehabilitation should be sequenced alongside security and governance interventions to maximise stabilisation outcomes.
- Strengthening inclusive local governance and representation is essential for long-term stability. Establishing a formal district council will enhance participatory decision-making, accountability, and youth engagement. Measures to formally include women and youth in governance structures, supported by capacity-building initiatives, will improve the responsiveness, legitimacy, and inclusivity of local leadership.
- Supporting economic recovery and livelihood restoration is critical to translating security into sustainable development. Targeted programmes should focus on reviving agriculture, petty trade, and small enterprises, with particular attention to women, youth, and returnees. Provision of agricultural inputs, irrigation support, micro-grants, and access to capital will help households restart income-generating activities and mitigate the effects of high food prices. Livelihood interventions should be closely aligned with local market recovery to ensure sustainability.

- Facilitating the return and reintegration of displaced persons requires targeted assistance for housing reconstruction, access to essential services, and livelihood support. Financial constraints, rather than security concerns, remain the primary barrier for many displaced households, and interventions should address these gaps through low-cost shelter solutions and start-up assistance for livelihoods. A coordinated approach will ensure that reintegration is inclusive, conflict-sensitive, and sustainable.
- Enhancing access to justice is essential for equitable and stable governance. While traditional mechanisms such as Xeer remain trusted, formal justice services are largely absent. Investments in mobile courts, trained legal personnel, and legal aid initiatives are needed to complement customary systems. Strengthening the linkages between Xeer, Sharia, and formal legal frameworks will improve consistency, fairness, and the protection of vulnerable groups, particularly women. Legal awareness programmes should be implemented to ensure communities understand their rights and available justice mechanisms.
- Improving information access and reducing misinformation is another strategic priority. Establishing a community radio station or hyper-local broadcasting platform would provide verified and locally relevant information. Expanding access to electricity and communication devices, alongside digital literacy initiatives—particularly for women and older adults—will enhance the safe use of digital platforms. Formalised channels for information-sharing between authorities, security actors, and communities will reduce reliance on informal networks and improve timely decision-making during critical situations.
- Finally, all interventions should be part of a coordinated, sustained engagement strategy that integrates security, governance, livelihoods, basic services, justice, and information access. Aligning humanitarian, stabilisation, and development efforts will maximise impact, avoid duplication, and leverage Awdhegle's strong social cohesion and public trust as a foundation for locally driven recovery. Timely and well-aligned action is critical to ensure that the town transitions from fragile recovery to durable stability and long-term development.